MOCK TEST 26

📖 READING

5 parts · 35 questions

⏱ 60 minutes

Vaqt: 60 daqiqa. Javoblarni javoblar varaqasiga o'tkazishni unutmang.

PART 1

Questions 1–7

Read the text. Fill in each gap with ONE word. You must use a word which is somewhere in the rest of the text.

FRIENDSHIP AND LOVE

A strong friendship takes a significant amount of time to develop. It will not just magically mature overnight. A **Q1** _____ involves committing oneself to help another person whenever a need arises. I believe that, nothing can replace a true friend, not material objects, or money, and definitely not a boy.

I met this guy a couple summers ago who **Q2**_____ ended up spending almost all of my free time with. His parents did not approve of our dating because of our age difference, but we did anyway. He had told me the day we met that he had joined the air force and would leave for overseas that coming October. After three months had passed, the time came when he had to **Q3**_____. This left me feeling completely alone.

I turned to my friends for support, but to my surprise, they did not really care. I had spent so much time with this **Q4** _____ and so little time with them, that they did not feel sorry for me when he left. For so long **Q5**_____ had become the only constant in my life, and I had taken them for granted over something I could not guarantee would even last.

When my boyfriend came back, our relationship changed. I tried to fix all the aspects in my life that had gone so wrong in the previous six months.

This experience taught me that true friendships will only survive if one puts forth effort to make them last. Keeping friends close will guarantee that someone will always have a shoulder to cry on. When a **Q6**_____ falls apart, a friend will always do everything in their power to make everything less painful. As for me, I try to keep my **Q7**_____ as close as I can. I know they will always support me in whatever I do, and to them, I am eternally grateful for a second chance.

PART 2

Questions 8–12

The people all want to read a book. Read the descriptions of eight books. Decide which book would be most suitable for each person. For Questions 8-12, select the best book.

A) Henry Jowett 'The Portrait of a Woman' — The charming Evelyn Blanchet was a French woman who came to England in the eighteenth century and won the hearts of young men wherever she appeared. This enjoyable romance shows us the elegant evening dresses, the beautiful rooms, and Evelyn's gleaming eyes in an imaginary world full of gardens and palaces.

B) Patience Jones 'The English Corner' — In a quiet English village by the sea, a young French widow gets a second chance at love. Annabel Ginger hasn't been back to the Village of Abberton since she buried her husband two years ago. Now she's returning with her 4-year-old daughter, Alice.

C) Robin Greene 'Migration' — In the dark future of Jupiter XI, more than 90 percent of the world's population died. Most people killed themselves or were killed by others who were listening to voices steering their dreadful actions. Those who survived live in a very hostile environment. There are so many different twists or unexpected turns.

D) Ann Kaufman 'Baby Dance' — This fabulous board book follows five American puppies (including a rather cheeky Yorkie) as they play and dance the day away. Using delightful rhyme and simple language, an American author Ann Kaufman has created a fun, rhythmical story that is a joy to read and alluring to little ears.

E) Bruce Nolan 'Landia' — Landia is a medieval world filled with pirates and warriors, adventures and battles, and a group of boys trying to find their place in the world. The story focuses on a bunch of naughty boys who, as part of their coming of age, must go through six months of tough, physical training on land and sea to become warriors.

F) Automobile Association 'Walks and Tours in England' — A free guide (French edition) with practical tips and advice to help you get the most out of your trip to the United Kingdom. The guide includes detailed information on history, museums, galleries, churches as well as some useful information about accommodation. There are suggested tour routes, maps and directions.

G) Izaak Watson 'The Perfect Storm' — The "Silver Guide" series from St. George's Press has been around since the late '60s and is known for its comprehensive coverage of a wide range of topics related to nature. "The Perfect Storm" is no exception. The book is widely considered to be one of the leading guidebooks for novice and experienced anglers.

H) Doris McCartney 'The Princess' — Open the book, and you won't be disappointed, for what follows is a fascinating adventure with fantastic places and amazing creatures, all to be found just on the verge of reality, if only you could squeeze through the lavender hedge at the bottom of the garden to find it.

8

Q8

James is looking for a book for his granddaughter's fourth birthday present. Ideally, it should be about animals or elves and be a story he can read to her many times.

9

Q9

Susan is twenty-one and works for a multinational company. She likes romance novels very much, especially if they contain descriptions of fashionable clothes, magnificent houses, and parties.

10

Q10

Andre is from Paris and travels across England on business very often. He would like a book that offers accurate information as he sometimes has time for sightseeing between business meetings.

11

Q11

Tia is a chemistry student, but she would like to read science fiction in her free time. She wants to buy a well-written book with a surprise at the end.

12

Q12

Peter wants to buy a book as a present for his friend Robin. Robin is keen on fishing and likes spending time in nature.

PART 3

Questions 13–17

Read the text and choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below. There are more headings than paragraphs, so you will not use all of them. You cannot use any heading more than once.

List of Headings:

I) Examples of customization
II) Unusual keepsakes
III) A new approach
IV) A simple cell phone
V) Unbelievable material
VI) A strange TV
VII) Number of products shown on the festival

13. Paragraph A **14. Paragraph B** **15. Paragraph C**
16. Paragraph D **17. Paragraph E**

SIMPLICITY REIGNS AT LONDON'S BIGGEST DESIGN FESTIVAL.

A. One was the launch of two consumer electronics products designed to simplify and beautify our technology-addled lives. Both chose the new London Design Festival venue of Somerset House to show their wares. The first was a mobile phone launched by Swiss company Punkt and designed by Jasper Morrison that allows users to make calls and texts only (well, it has an alarm clock and an address book too). Punkt founder Petter Neby doesn't believe it will replace your smart phone but suggests users fit it with the same SIM card as your main phone and use it in the evenings, weekends and on holiday.

B. Customizable online furniture was also very much in vogue at this year's festival. But rest assured, weird and unreliable software or off-the-wall designs sent to a 3D printer somewhere and arriving months later, seem to be a thing of the past. Customization may finally have come of age. Two examples were Scandi-brand Hem that combined good design by the likes of Luca Nichetto, Form Us With Love and Sylvain Willenz with affordable price points. The fact that the brand opened a pop-up store in Covent Garden during the festival is a recognition of the importance of both physical and online spaces that work seamlessly together.

C. A definite highlight was the massive space taken over by the Design & Crafts Council of Ireland and filled with weavers and potters doing their thing and showing their wares. Irish Design had another delectable stand over at the Rochelle School in East London too. The Souvenir Project was a series of nine non-cliché souvenirs made in Ireland and included a rainbow plate by Nicholas Mosse Pottery that featured rows of animals, flowers and watering cans and commemorated the legalization of same-sex marriage in Ireland in May 2015.

D. If there was one material that could be said to define the festival it might just be Jesmonite, the wonder man-made building composite. Lighter and more sustainable than concrete, its dramatic capabilities were brought to life by London-based design studio PINCH and their tour-de-force limited edition Nim table and Swedish artist Hilda Hellström's giant colorful volcano made for the restaurant in London's Ace Hotel. A show called Matter of Stuff near Covent Garden was in on the jesmonite act too, but even more intriguingly was presenting vases made out of Propolis, a resinous material collected by bees and used to seal gaps in hives that, according to their designer Marlene Huissoud, behaves like glass.

E. Finally, this was the year that Chinese Design finally displayed a well-edited and inspired showcase of products. Despite the mouthful of a title, Icon Presents: Hi Design Shanghai stand at 100% Design was a meaningful selection of designers exploring materials and ideas. Young design duo Yuue's offerings were the most representative of a new conceptual approach to design that seems to be emerging. Their lamps were functional but also thought-provoking and humorous. What more could one want from the stuff that surrounds us?

PART 4

Questions 18–28

Read the following text for questions 18-28.

SEA MONSTERS

Sea monsters are the stuff of legend – lurking not just in the depths of the oceans, but also the darker corners of our minds. What is it that draws us to these creatures?

"This inhuman place makes human monsters," wrote Stephen King in his novel The Shining. Many academics agree that monsters lurk in the deepest recesses, they prowl through our ancestral minds appearing in the half-light, under the bed – or at the bottom of the sea.

"They don't really exist, but they play a huge role in our mindscapes, in our dreams, stories, nightmares, myths and so on," says Matthias Classen, assistant professor of literature and media at Aarhus University in Denmark, who studies monsters in literature. "Monsters say something about human psychology, not the world."

One Norse legend talks of the Kraken, a deep sea creature that was the curse of fishermen. If sailors found a place with many fish, most likely it was the monster that was driving them to the surface. If it saw the ship it would pluck the hapless sailors from the boat and drag them to a watery grave.

This terrifying legend occupied the mind and pen of the poet Alfred Lord Tennyson too. In his short 1830 poem The Kraken he wrote: "Below the thunders of the upper deep, / Far far beneath in the abysmal sea, / His ancient, dreamless, uninvaded sleep / The Kraken sleepeth."

The deeper we travel into the ocean, the deeper we delve into our own psyche. And when we can go no further – there lurks the Kraken.

Most likely the Kraken is based on a real creature – the giant squid. The huge mollusc takes pride of place as the personification of the terrors of the deep sea. Sailors would have encountered it at the surface, dying, and probably thrashing about. It would have made a weird sight, "about the most alien thing you can imagine," says Edith Widder, CEO at the Ocean Research and Conservation Association.

"It has eight lashing arms and two slashing tentacles growing straight out of its head and it's got serrated suckers that can latch on to the slimiest of prey and it's got a parrot beak that can rip flesh. It's got an eye the size of your head, it's got a jet propulsion system and three hearts that pump blue blood."

The giant squid continued to dominate stories of sea monsters with the famous 1870 novel, Twenty Thousand Leagues Under the Sea, by Jules Verne. Verne's submarine fantasy is a classic story of puny man against a gigantic squid.

The monster needed no embellishment – this creature was scary enough, and Verne incorporated as much fact as possible into the story, says Emily Alder from Edinburgh Napier University. "Twenty Thousand Leagues Under the Sea and another contemporaneous book, Victor Hugo's Toilers of the Sea, both tried to represent the giant squid as they might have been actual zoological animals, much more taking the squid as a biological creature than a mythical creature." It was a given that the squid was vicious and would readily attack humans given the chance.

That myth wasn't busted until 2012, when Edith Widder and her colleagues were the first people to successfully film giant squid under water and see first-hand the true character of the monster of the deep. They realised previous attempts to film squid had failed because the bright lights and noisy thrusters on submersibles had frightened them away.

By quietening down the engines and using bioluminescence to attract it, they managed to see this most extraordinary animal in its natural habitat. It serenely glided into view, its body rippled with metallic colours of bronze and silver. Its huge, intelligent eye watched the submarine warily as it delicately picked at the bait with its beak. It was balletic and mesmeric. It could not have been further from the gnashing, human-destroying creature of myth and literature. In reality this is a gentle giant that is easily scared and pecks at its food.

Another giant squid lies peacefully in the Natural History Museum in London, in the Spirit Room, where it is preserved in a huge glass case. In 2004 it was caught in a fishing net off the Falkland Islands and died at the surface. The crew immediately froze its body and it was sent to be preserved in the museum by the Curator of Molluscs, Jon Ablett. It is called Archie, an affectionate short version of its Latin name Architeuthis dux. It is the longest preserved specimen of a giant squid in the world.

Do the following statements agree with the information given? Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

18 **Matthias Classen is unsure about the possibility of monster's existence**
A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

19 **Kraken is probably based on an imaginary animal**
A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

20 **Previous attempts on filming the squid had failed due to the fact that the creature was scared**
A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

21 **Giant squid was caught alive in 2004 and brought to the museum**
A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

22 **Jon Ablett admits that he likes Archie**
A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

23 **According to Classen, people can be scared both by imaginary and real monsters**
A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

24 **Werner Herzog suggests that Kraken is essential to the ocean**
A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

Choose the correct letter A, B, C or D.

25 **Who wrote a novel about a giant squid?**
A) Emily Alder
B) Stephen King
C) Alfred Lord Tennyson
D) Jules Verne

26 **What, of the featuring body parts, mollusc DOESN'T have?**
A) two tentacles
B) serrated suckers
C) beak
D) smooth suckers

27 **Which of the following applies to the bookish Kraken?**
A) notorious
B) scary
C) weird
D) harmless

28 **Where can we see a giant squid?**

A) at the museum
B) at a seaside
C) on TV
D) in supermarkets

PART 5 Questions 29–35

Read the text below and answer Questions 29-35.

THE END OF THE IPO

Not long ago, if you were a young, brash technologist with a world-conquering start-up idea, there was a good chance you spent much of your waking life working toward a single business milestone: taking your company public.

Though luminaries of the tech industry have always expressed skepticism and even hostility toward the finance industry, tech's dirty secret was that it looked to Wall Street and the ritual of a public offering for affirmation — not to mention wealth.

The delay in I.P.O.s has altered how some venture capital firms do business. Rather than waiting for an initial offering, Maveron, for instance, says it now sells its stake in a start-up to other, larger private investors once it has made about 100 times its initial investment. It is the sort of return that was once only possible after an I.P.O.

But there is also a downside to the new aversion to initial offerings. When the unicorns do eventually go public and begin to soar — or whatever it is that fantastical horned beasts tend to do when they're healthy — the biggest winners will be the private investors that are now bearing most of the risk.

It used to be that public investors who got in on the ground floor of an initial offering could earn historic gains. If you invested $1,000 in Amazon at its I.P.O. in 1997, you would now have nearly $250,000. If you had invested $1,000 in Microsoft in 1986, you would have close to half a million. Public investors today are unlikely to get anywhere near such gains from tech I.P.O.s. By the time tech companies come to the market, the biggest gains have already been extracted by private backers.

Just 53 technology companies went public in 2014, which is around the median since 1980, but far fewer than during the boom of the late 1990s and 2000, when hundreds of tech companies went public annually, according to statistics maintained by Jay Ritter, a professor of finance at the University of Florida.

Initial public offerings were also ways to compensate employees and founders who owned lots of stock, but there are now novel mechanisms — such as selling shares on a secondary market — for insiders to cash in on some of their shares in private companies. Still, some observers cautioned that the new trend may be a bad deal for employees who aren't given much information about the company's performance.

If the delay in I.P.O.s becomes a normal condition for Silicon Valley, some observers say tech companies may need to consider new forms of compensation for workers. "We probably need to fundamentally rethink how do private companies compensate employees, because that's going to be an issue," said Mr. Kupor, of Andreessen Horowitz.

If the private investors are wrong, employees, founders and a lot of hedge funds could be in for a reckoning. But if they're right, it will be you and me wearing the frown — the public investors who missed out on the next big thing.

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

29 **How much funds would you gain by now, if you had invested 1000$ in the Amazon in 1997?**

A) 250,000$
B) close to 500,000$
C) It is not stated in the text
D) No funds

30 **In which time period was the biggest number of companies going public?**

A) early 1990s
B) late 1900s and 2000s
C) 1980s
D) late 1990s

Complete the sentences below. Write ONLY ONE WORD from the passage for each answer.

SENTENCE COMPLETION

Skepticism was always expected by the **31** _____ of tech industry.

The new aversion to initial offerings has its **32** _____.

Selling shares on a secondary market is considered a **33** _____ mechanism.

Workers' compensation might be an **34** _____

The public investors who failed to participate in the next big thing might be the ones wearing the **35** _____.

MOCK TEST 26

35 answers

1	Friendship	**13**	IV	**25**	D
2	I	**14**	I	**26**	D
3	Leave	**15**	II	**27**	B
4	Guy	**16**	V	**28**	A
5	They / friends	**17**	III	**29**	A
6	Relationship	**18**	False / B	**30**	B
7	Friends	**19**	False / B	**31**	Luminaries
8	D	**20**	True / A	**32**	Downside
9	A	**21**	False / B	**33**	Novel
10	F	**22**	Not Given / C	**34**	Issue
11	C	**23**	True / A	**35**	Frown
12	G	**24**	Not Given / C		